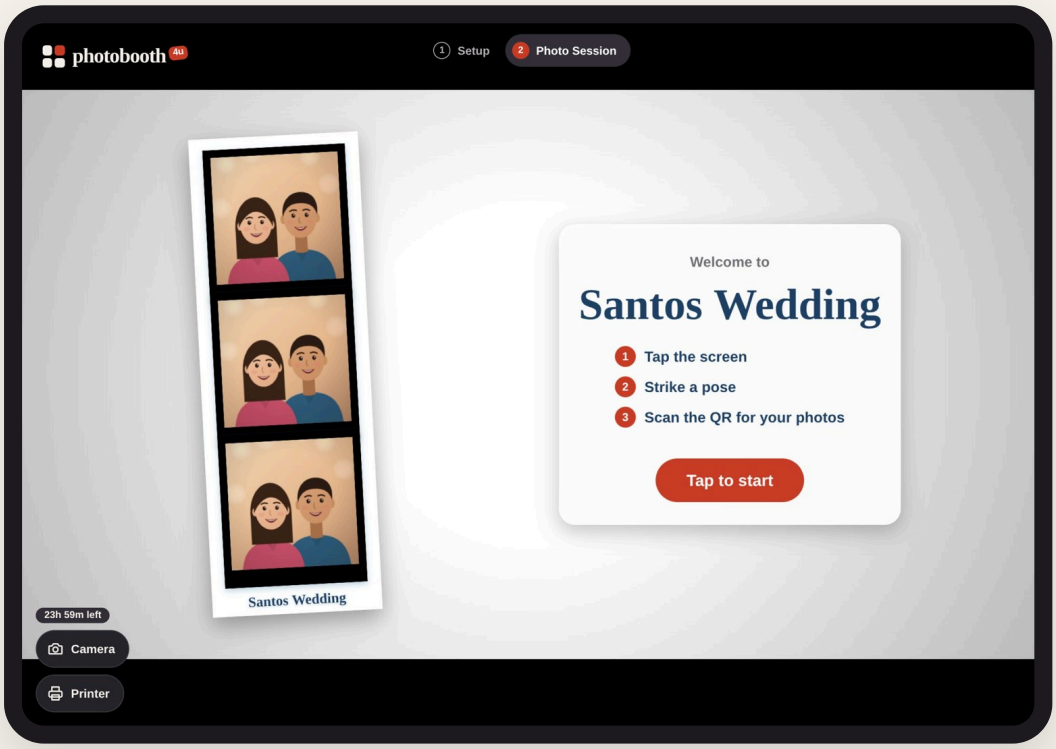
photobooth 4u

Your tablet, *ready* to be a booth.

How to run photobooth4u on an **iPad or Android tablet**: settings, camera, printing and keeping guests in the booth. In a hurry? **Page 2 is a one-page quick start** for event day.



★ Quick start (page 2)

01 What you need

02 Prepare the tablet

03 Open & unlock the booth

04 Camera & position

05 Guest-only mode

06 Printing from a tablet

07 Weak or no internet

08 After the event

09 Troubleshooting & help

★ EVENT DAY

Quick start

Do these in order. Each step has its own page if you need more detail.

1. **Charge and mount the tablet**

   Tablet on its charger, on a stand at the guests' eye level, **screen and front camera facing the guests**. Landscape works best. *(Page 5)*

2. **Check the tablet settings**

   Screen never locks, **Do Not Disturb** on, Low Power / Battery Saver off, volume up for the countdown beeps. *(Page 3)*

3. **Connect to the internet**

   Venue Wi-Fi, a pocket Wi-Fi or a phone hotspot. If you print over Wi-Fi, put the **printer on the same network**. *(Pages 7–8)*

4. **Open the booth**

   iPad: Safari. **Android:** Chrome. Go to **photobooth4u.netlify.app**. The tablet is already unlocked from last time. Tap **Allow** if it asks for the camera. *(Page 4)*

5. **Check Setup**

   Design, name and date, layout. Lifetime codes: type the **event name** in **6 Share**. Your last setup is saved, so usually you only change the name.

6. **Printer (if your package has printing)**

   Tap **Printer** (bottom left), pick the paper size, then do one test print and choose your printer in the print sheet. Optional: **Print automatically after each session**. *(Page 7)*

7. **Do one test session**

   Take a session yourself, **scan the QR with your phone**, and check the print.

8. **Lock it for guests**

   Turn on **Lock booth** (if included) and **Guided Access** (iPad) or **App pinning** (Android) so guests stay in the booth. Open **Photo Session**. You're ready. *(Page 6)*

Good habits

- Keep the booth open in **one tab**. Don't close it while photos are uploading.
- Wipe the front camera lens before guests arrive.

If something goes wrong

- Camera black or frozen: **reload the page**. Your setup is saved.
- Still stuck: page 9, or message us.

01 · BEFORE YOU START

What you need

MUST HAVE

- **iPad** or **Android tablet**, kept up to date. A phone works too.
- **Tablet stand or tripod mount** at eye level
- **Charger** and a long cable or extension cord
- **Internet**: venue Wi-Fi, pocket Wi-Fi or a phone hotspot

NICE TO HAVE

- **Ring light** or soft light facing the guests
- **Photo printer** on Wi-Fi (e.g. Canon Selphy), if your package has printing
- A printed **QR sign** for the table (page 8)
- A backdrop and props

02 · ONCE PER TABLET

Prepare the tablet

So the screen never sleeps and no pop-ups land on top of the booth during the event.

IPAD

- **Settings → Display & Brightness → Auto-Lock → Never**
- **Control Centre → Focus → Do Not Disturb** (no message pop-ups)
- **Settings → Battery → Low Power Mode**: off
- **Settings → Apps → Safari → Camera → Allow** (on older iPadOS: Settings → Safari → Camera)
- **Control Centre → Rotation Lock**: on, once the iPad is the right way round
- Brightness and volume up

ANDROID

- **Settings → Display → Screen timeout**: the longest
- **Quick settings → Do Not Disturb**: on
- **Settings → Battery → Battery saver / Power saving**: off
- **Play Store → Chrome → Update**
- **Quick settings → Auto-rotate**: off, once the tablet is the right way round
- Brightness and volume up

While the booth is open it keeps the screen awake by itself. The settings above are the backup, for example after you switch apps.

03 · FIRST TIME ON EACH TABLET

Open & unlock the booth

1. **Open the website**

   iPad: Safari. **Android:** Chrome. Go to **photobooth4u.netlify.app**.

2. **Enter your code**

   Type your `PB-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX` code and tap **Unlock**. Lifetime codes open **My Events** first: tap **Open photo booth**.

3. **Allow the camera**

   Tap **Allow** when the tablet asks. The live view appears in Setup.

4. **Next time, just open the website**

   The tablet stays unlocked. Each tablet uses one of your **device slots**. Lifetime codes can see and **remove** devices in **My Events → Your details & devices**.

Keep it in a normal tab

On an iPad, run the booth in a **Safari tab**. If you added it to the Home Screen, the AirPrint sheet may not open from there.

Don't use **Private browsing** or **Clear History and Website Data**: they sign the tablet out and remove photos still waiting to upload.

EVERY EVENT

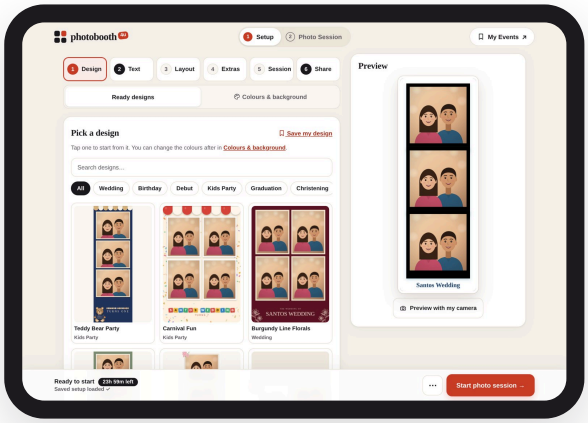
Set up the event

In **Setup**, go through the 6 steps with **Next**: **Design**, **Text** (name and date), **Layout**, **Extras**, **Session** (countdown, camera, light, lock) and **Share** (event name for lifetime codes, the All photos QR). Then tap **Start photo session**.

Everything saves by itself, and every device on your code gets the same design. More detail: the **Setup guide**, page 4.

TWO TABLETS AT ONE EVENT?

Type the **exact same event name** on both. They share one gallery, one QR and one design.



Setup on an iPad: the 6 steps across the top, preview on the right.

04 · LOOKING GOOD

Camera & position

The booth uses the tablet's **front camera**, so guests see themselves on the screen while they pose. On tablets the session fills the whole screen.

1. ### Height and distance

   Camera at **eye level**, about **1.5–2 m** from the guests. For groups, step the stand back rather than zooming.

2. ### Light in front, not behind

   Light should face the guests. Avoid a bright window behind them. A **ring light** next to the tablet helps a lot.

3. ### Dim room? Use Screen flash

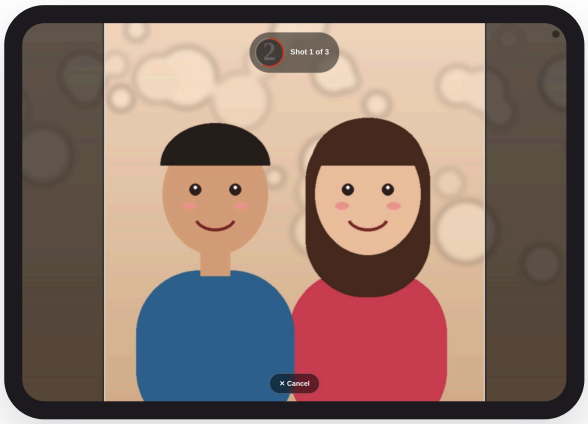
   Setup → 7 Session → Light, sound and start → Screen flash: the screen turns white for each photo and lights up faces.

4. ### Mirror

   Mirror flips the preview like a mirror. The final photo looks exactly like the preview.

5. ### Choose another camera

   Tap **Camera** (bottom left) to switch. The back camera is sharper but faces away from the screen, so guests can't see themselves.



The countdown fills the screen on a tablet.

Using your DSLR or a capture card

ANDROID

Tablet app (recommended): Nikon, **Canon EOS** and **Sony Alpha** work over USB with **live view and the real shutter**. Plug the camera into the tablet's USB port with a **data** cable (USB-C or an OTG adapter), switch it on and tap **OK** when Android asks to allow it. In the booth pick **Nikon / Canon / Sony camera over USB cable** in the Camera list. **Canon:** Live View shoot on, mode dial P / Tv / Av / M. **Sony:** USB Connection → **PC Remote**. **Nikon:** PTP / MTP mode. Save as JPEG. Other makes: use the camera's webcam mode or an HDMI capture card. In Chrome instead of the app, use **Camera → DSLR / mirrorless over USB** (test at **photobooth4u.netlify.app/camera-test/**).

IPAD

A DSLR can't be controlled from an iPad. On an **iPad with USB-C** (iPadOS 17 or newer), a **USB webcam or HDMI capture card** can show up in the Camera menu. Test it at home before the event.

05 · SELF-SERVICE BOOTH

Guest-only mode

Two locks work together: **Lock booth** hides Setup inside photobooth4u, and the tablet's own lock keeps guests from leaving the browser.

1. **Lock booth (if your package has it)**

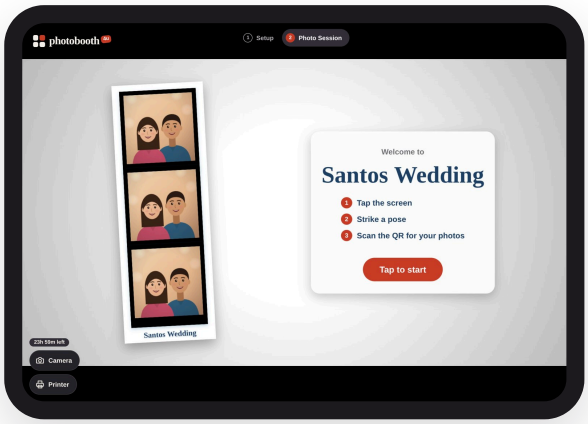
   Setup → 7 Session → Lock booth: set a 4-digit **PIN**, then **Lock booth now**. Guests only see start, photos, QR and print. To get back in, tap the **small lock** in the top-right corner and enter the PIN.

2. **iPad: Guided Access**

   Settings → Accessibility → Guided Access: on, and set a passcode. Open the booth in Safari, **triple-click the top button** (or the Home button) → **Start**. To end it, triple-click again and enter the passcode.

3. **Android: App pinning**

   Settings → Security (or Security & privacy → More security settings) → **App pinning**: on, with "Ask for PIN before unpinning". Open **Recent apps**, tap Chrome's icon → **Pin**. To unpin, hold **Back + Recents** (or swipe up and hold) and enter your PIN.



The welcome screen guests see. Your event name comes from Setup.

Start without touching

TAP

The default. Guests tap the screen to start, and tap again for each photo if you chose **Wait for a tap**.

WAVE

Guests wave at the camera to start. **Setup → 7 Session → Light, sound and start → Start**.

SMILE

Starts when someone smiles at the camera. Works best with good light on faces.

Countdown beeps and shutter click are on by default (same section). Keep the tablet's volume up and the side switch off silent.

06 · IF YOUR PACKAGE INCLUDES PRINTING

Printing from a tablet

Two ways. Pick the one that matches your printer.

A · WI-FI PRINTER

Canon Selphy CP1300 / CP1500, Epson, HP and other **AirPrint** (iPad) or **Mopria** (Android) printers.

1. Put the printer and the tablet on the **same Wi-Fi**.
2. In the booth tap **Printer**, pick the paper size, and print one test.
3. Choose your printer in the print sheet. The tablet remembers it.
4. Optional: **Print automatically after each session**. The print sheet then opens by itself and the guest just taps **Print**.

Android: if no printer shows, install **Mopria Print Service** or **Canon Print Service** from the Play Store and turn it on. The **Android app** (APK) finds Wi-Fi and USB printers itself and prints with no sheet: see photobooth4u.netlify.app/how-to-print-android/.

B · LAPTOP PRINT STATION

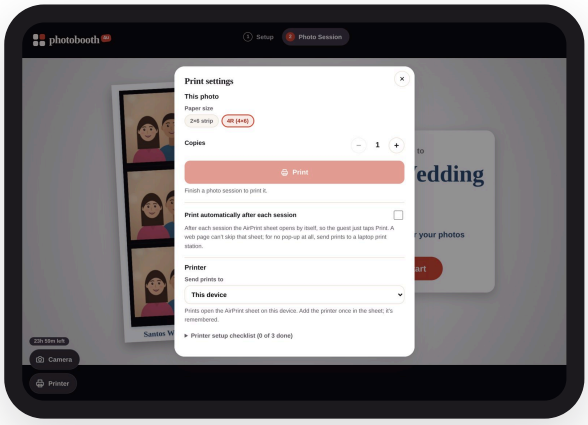
For **DNP / HiTi** printers (not AirPrint), or when guests shouldn't see a print sheet.

1. On the laptop next to the printer, open the **Print Helper** and **photobooth4u.netlify.app/print-station/**, sign in with your code, and pick a printer for each size.
2. On the tablet: **Printer → Send prints to → Laptop print station**. The booth shows when the station is on.
3. Prints go to the laptop and print with **no pop-up**, including Print automatically.

Free trial: the tablet shows a 6-digit **pairing code**; type it on the print-station page.

SELPHY TIPS

- **No venue Wi-Fi?** Connect the Selphy and the tablet to the **same pocket Wi-Fi or phone hotspot**. The Selphy's own direct Wi-Fi has no internet, so photos would only upload later.
- Choose the **Canon Selphy postcard (100×148 mm)** size. Strip layouts print two strips on one postcard to cut.
- About **40 seconds per print**: plan 1 print per session at busy events.
- Lifetime codes choose their paper sizes and print limits in **My Events → Printing**.



Printer: paper size, Print automatically, and where prints go.

07 · WHEN THE VENUE'S INTERNET IS BAD

Weak or no internet

1. **Open the booth while you're online**

   Load the booth and check Setup before the event starts, while the internet works.

2. **Keep going if it drops**

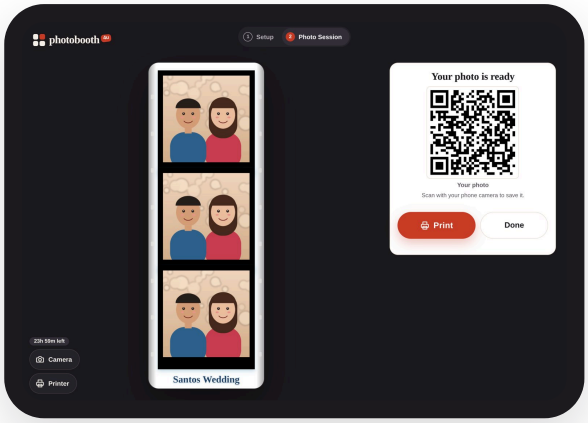
   Sessions carry on. Each photo is **kept on the tablet** and uploads by itself when the internet is back. Guests still get their QR: *"Scan now · your photo arrives once the booth is back online."*

3. **Put out the QR sign**

   Setup → 6 Share → Download QR sign, then print it for the table. Guests can scan it any time to see every photo of the event.

4. **Keep the tab open until it's empty**

   The Photo Session panel shows **Waiting to upload**. Leave the booth open on internet until that list is gone.



After each session: the guest's own QR, Print and Done.

Guest payments: QR payment needs internet; **vouchers work offline**. With "QR + vouchers" the booth switches to vouchers by itself when the internet drops. Setup guide pages 9–10.

08 · AFTER THE EVENT

Send the photos to your client

1. **Open My Events**

   In Setup, tap **My Events ↗** (top right): it opens already signed in. Or use **photobooth4u.netlify.app/lifetime/** on any phone.

2. **Copy the link or show the QR**

   Send the **online gallery** by Messenger. Your client can **Download all** there.

7-DAY RULE

Photos are deleted **7 days after the event's last photo**. Send the link the same day.

09 · QUICK FIXES

Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	FIX
"We need access to your camera"	**iPad:** Settings → Apps → Safari → Camera → Allow, then reload. **Android:** tap the icon left of the address → Permissions → Camera → Allow, then reload.
Camera black or frozen	Usually after switching apps or a call. **Reload the page**. Close other apps that use the camera.
The screen dims or locks	iPad: Auto-Lock → Never. Android: Screen timeout to the longest. Keep the tablet charging.
Messages or calls pop up	Turn on **Do Not Disturb** before the event.
Guests leave the booth or open other apps	Use **Guided Access** (iPad) or **App pinning** (Android), plus **Lock booth**. Page 6.
No print sheet appears (iPad)	Open the booth in a **Safari tab**, not from a Home Screen icon. Or use a laptop print station.
Printer isn't in the list	Same Wi-Fi as the tablet? Restart the printer. Android: install **Mopria** or **Canon Print Service**.
"Already used on another device"	All device slots are taken. Lifetime: **My Events → Your details & devices → Remove** an old one. Otherwise message us.
"Photos waiting to upload"	The internet dropped. Keep the booth open: they upload by themselves, or tap **Retry now**.
The QR code doesn't appear	Check the internet, and that the event name is set in **Setup → 6 Share**.
Forgot your code	**My Events → Forgot your code?** It's emailed to the address on your account.
Countdown is silent	Volume up, side switch off silent, and **Countdown beeps** on in Setup → 7 Session.

Before every event

- ☐ Tablet charged, charger packed
- ☐ Booth opens and the camera works
- ☐ Printer on the same Wi-Fi, test print done
- ☐ Do Not Disturb on, Auto-Lock: Never
- ☐ Event name set in Setup → 6 Share
- ☐ QR sign printed for the table

Need help? Message us.

We're on Facebook Messenger: **m.me/roktetnachi**

Message us